Patrick Bellanca

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Lead Game Designer with 18+ years of experience owning core gameplay loops, meta systems, progression architecture, and live-service content from zero-to-one concept through launch and live operations—including hit mobile F2P coin-looter/roll-mechanic franchise *Monopoly GO!* ($6B+ revenue) and 13 annual *Madden NFL* titles. Proven track record rapidly building playable prototypes, partnering with product directors, data scientists, and studio leadership to translate playtests and live player data into high-retention systemic updates, and reviewing/mentoring junior designers across multidisciplinary pods.

TECHNICAL SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

Design Direction & Mentorship	Project Design Direction, Stakeholder & Studio Leadership Alignment, Design Reviews & Feedback, Mentoring
Systems & Live-Service Design	Core Loops, Meta & Progression Architecture, Live-Operations, Player Retention, KPI & Telemetry Analysis
F2P Systems, Meta & Live-Ops	Rapid Playable Prototyping, Clear PRDs & System Documentation, Playtest Facilitation, Iterative Tuning & Polish
Engines & Technical Execution	Unreal Engine 4/5, Unity/C#, Godot, UEFN, Roblox, Cross-Disciplinary Production Pipelines

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Indie Game Developer - Technical Fiction / Lake Effect Interactive *January 2026 – Present*

- Rapidly built playable prototypes of core gameplay loops, player abilities, and interactive systems, taking concepts from initial paper design to functional alpha in under 2 months.
- Built, scripted, and polished immersive gameplay scenarios and level mechanics using UE5 Blueprints and state-machine workflows
- Set technical and gameplay design direction in Unreal Engine 5 at Technical Fiction, establishing core mechanics, state-machine workflows, and polish standards.
- Founded independent studio Lake Effect Interactive to own end-to-end game design, production, and self-publishing of multiplayer titles.

Lead Content Designer — Mythical Games *September 2024 – December 2025*

- Owned design and implementation of gameplay systems and live-ops content pipelines supporting weekly and monthly live-service release cycles.

- Partnered with cross-functional product, engineering, and art leadership to validate feature architecture, progression flow, and systemic mechanics engineered for high-scale player retention.

Creative Lead — Sony Immersive Music Studios *June 2021 – April 2024*

- Directed the creative and technical vision for a portfolio of 5 licensed IP interactive game experiences built in UEFN and Roblox, reaching 100k+ active players.
- Fostered an open, humble, and collaborative team culture where team members shared ownership and championed the best ideas regardless of origin.
- Mentored designers and developers across disciplines to deliver memorable, narrative-infused interactive music spaces.

Lead Game Designer (*Monopoly GO!*) — Scopely *January 2020 – June 2021*

- Led a multidisciplinary pod of engineers, designers, and data scientists through full product development cycles on *Monopoly GO!* ($6B+ revenue), a premier F2P mobile roll/coin-looter hit.
- Guided team members through systemic feature design, hands-on engine implementation, and data-informed playtesting/iteration cycles to optimize core loop engagement.

Senior Game Designer — Backflip Studios *January 2019 – January 2020*

- Owned system design documentation, feature requirements (PRDs), and Unity/C#-based technical implementation for an unannounced free-to-play mobile IP.

Game Designer (*Madden NFL*) — EA Sports *October 2007 – January 2019*

- Served as Product Owner and Technical Designer for tentpole gameplay features across 13 annual shipped titles over an 11+ year tenure.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams of 30+ software engineers, applied scientists, and QA specialists to architect, build, and tune complex backend gameplay systems and authoring pipelines.
- Reviewed work and mentored entry-level designers joining annual production pipelines, coaching them from early layouts through bug triage and final ship.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Unreal Engine 5 C++ Game Development - Udemy, 2026

Master of Science in Information Technology (MSIT) - Rochester Institute of Technology, 2004